This Is Tomorrow

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Rock 'n' Roll Radio

PRO-01

It's raining.

No,

it is not.

It's the "Storm."

The "Storm" is coming.

NEWTON STREET

Aha ... Are you feeling seasick?

Open your eyes, followers!

It's 12 at noon and the rocking APPLe is welcoming the most unwelcome visitors ...

I'll hold of you a public hearing!

You stalkers, stalking me the Pirate for days.

Get ready to be shocked away by the rock'n'rolling coasters night and day!

Now, listen to Radio APPLe, come with me! Let's count down to ecstasy!

Three!

Two!

One!

Say your names, you British government stooges!

Say your names, you Manus Vindictae robbers!

You banned music?

You robbed traders?

Our lips are sealed and we wandered

but nothing's gonna change

our love for freedom ever!

Regulus: What's going on?! What happened?

APPLe: Captain! There is a huge black ship behind us. We are under attack!

Regulus: Bloody hell! Turn off the microphone!

Regulus: A bridge ...? Veined cannons ...? What the hell is that?!

Regulus: You've gotta be kidding! I only played a song!

APPLe: Captain, that is the emblem of Manus Vindictae!

The wind is wuthering.

Regulus: Manus Vindictae? Those terrorists?

Regulus: Is it because of my "little thing?" Or ...

Regulus: Ha. I get it ...

Regulus: Your accomplices are here!

Regulus: Remember, you're still captives of the Pirate Regulus! Order them to hold fire, or I'll ...

Another bomb hits the ship. The smell of gunpowder and sparks soon fill the air.

Regulus: *coughs*

APPLe: We are sinking. Please prepare to abandon the ship, my captain.

Regulus: Whoa ...

She scrambles to dispel the mute incantation on the captives.

Regulus: Hey! Hey, hey! I'll let you go. Just please don't sink my ship!

Regulus: My records are my most precious treasures ... Please, no violence!

Regulus: Hey! Can you hear me? Say something!

Male Investigator: ...

Female Investigator: ...

Female Investigator: *cough* ... We're not with them. We tried to tell you!

Male Investigator: We're investigators from the Foundation.

Female Investigator: You've got the wrong people.

Regulus: Ahh ...

Regulus: Protect the records!!

King's Trail

PRO-02

Sonetto: Regulus's ship's been sunk.

Sonetto: Landed ... Good. They landed safely.

Sonetto: Gosh! Those rioters are still after them! At this rate ...

Sonetto: My apologies, Timekeeper.

Sonetto: Are you feeling better?

Choices

1. Where ... are we?

2. Are you talking to ME?

Branch 1

Sonetto: Battersea Park. Chelsea is across the river.

Sonetto: I sent the backup request without authorization, and you were teleported here ...

Sonetto: It was rushed. The ritual wasn't ready, and you fell into a coma.

Branch 2

Sonetto: ... Of course! Timekeeper, I must offer you my deepest apologies.

Sonetto: I shouldn't have sent the backup request so hastily. The ritual wasn't ready.

Sonetto: But thank goodness you're awake now. There's no time to spare.

Shared continuation

Sonetto: Please allow me to report and request backup.

Vertin: Go ahead.

Sonetto: Two days ago, we met heavy resistance on our mission to register Regulus. She's even captured two of our investigators.

Sonetto: Unfortunately, she's now being pursued by Manus Vindictae.

Sonetto: Timekeeper, I formally request your aid. We must rescue the investigators, complete the registration of Regulus, and return to the research center before the arrival of the "Storm."

Choices

1. But ... why me?

Vertin: You know I'm not like you, Sonetto. You've trained your whole life to battle with arcanum. I ... took a different path ...

Sonetto: I know. You don't have to fight, Miss Vertin.

Sonetto: I just need you by my side. To guide me.

Sonetto: I've never known a person more perceptive in the arts of arcanum than you. And ...

Sonetto: According to the Field Mission Evacuation Instructions, we can request your aid within 24 hours of the "Storm."

Sonetto: Right, Timekeeper?

Vertin: You are a careful reader.

Vertin: I'll help you out. Don't worry.

Vertin: Fifty minutes left. Come on, let's move.

Sonetto: Please, use this. It'll send us directly to our destination.

Vertin: And this is ...?

Sonetto: A portable floppy disk containing the arcane skill "Teleport." I used one just now to bring you here.

Sonetto: Ahem ... They're still under experimentation, so they're not entirely stable. Madam Z only gave me three.

Sonetto: But if everything goes well, they'll save us a lot of time.

Sonetto: Envision the destination, speak its name, and the "Teleport" ritual will begin.

Choices

1. I see.

Female Investigator: There are too many of them! I can't hold on much longer! What's your status?

Male Investigator: The way back is blocked! I-I'm still trying to break through!

Female Investigator: Can we get back ... before the "Storm" ...?

The Manus Disciple: *roars*

Regulus: Oh, sugar! Sugar!

Regulus: All the money I saved ... My beloved APPLe ... And ...

Regulus: The tape drive I bought just yesterday ... All sunk to the bottom of the ocean!

Regulus: Don't be so smug! If I hadn't been protecting the records, I would've beaten the lot of you to a pulp!

The Manus Disciple: Give ... stone ...

Regulus: Ah!! What are you doing you bastard!

Regulus: My records! Pete Townshend! The John "Thunderfingers" live show!!!

Regulus: **I'm gonna kill you!!**

APPLe: Captain, behind you!

The Manus Disciple: *roars*

Vertin: Found them.

Vertin: Enemy ahead. Now!

Sonetto: Ascoltare. Capire. Pregare. Perdonare.

Sonetto: Ed è subito sera!

As the light shines, the enemies disappear in the blink of an eye.

Regulus: Huh? Who's there?

Female Investigator: That incantation ... could it be ...?

Male Investigator: It's the Chief Investigator! Yes! The Chief's here!

The light of "Teleport" fades away. Two figures show up on the shore.

Male Investigator: Chief! You arrived just in time! How did you know!?

Sonetto: I didn't. It's all thanks to the Timekeeper ...

Sonetto: Predicting the enemy's movement mid-teleportation ... you're even more perceptive than I thought!

Female Investigator: You're ... the Timekeeper?

Female Investigator: Hm. So the "Storm" is coming soon.

Vertin: Indeed. We have 45 minutes.

Vertin: I'll do my best to help before the "Storm" arrives.

Vertin: Now everyone, get ready to break through!

Vertin: Regulus, you're doing this too.

Regulus: Huh?

Regulus: *sighs* ... Fine. But only because you saved me. Then we're even!

She carefully hides her records behind a stone, joining the team unwillingly.

Vertin: Sonetto, your assistance please.

Vertin: The breach is behind us. The alley towards King's Road!

Teleport

PRO-03

Sonetto: We've got some distance from them for now ...

Female Investigator: Chief, are there any "Teleport" floppy disks left? We need to go now!

Sonetto: This is the last one. Let's take Regulus back.

Regulus: Umm? Where are we going?

Sonetto: Somewhere safe. We won't hurt you.

Sonetto: We are investigators from the St. Pavlov Foundation. As far as we are aware, you have not registered for the arcanum license.

Sonetto: Unauthorized use of arcanum is a violation of the Public Security Law. You are required to cooperate with our investigation and registration process.

Sonetto: Just come back with us to the research center and—

Sonetto: Sonetto looks at the sky, where thunder is bursting constantly.

Sonetto: We need to move quickly.

Regulus: Huh? Are you ... recruiting me?

Regulus: Fine! Fine! I'll go with you. But, could you show me the floppy disk first?

Sonetto: Sure. Go ahead.

Regulus: Wow ... so incantations can really be recorded and read!

Regulus: A floppy disk that stores advanced arcane skills. Awesome! If only I could take a look inside ...

Regulus: Hmm ... so this is where you start the ritual ... looks like a signature will work ...

Sonetto: That's right. I heard you were a fan of technolo- ...

Female Investigator: Everyone—get down!

Sonetto: Ambush!

Vertin: *cough* ... Is anyone hurt?

The Manus Believer: *roars* Give me ...!

Vertin: Careful! There's another gang of rioters! They're blocking the way ahead!

Sonetto: Manus Vindictae has been silent for some time ... Why are there so many of them now?

Vertin: We need to take them down first. Sonetto, your assistance, please!

Sonetto: That was close. We finally got rid of them.

Sonetto: Let's get a move on. Time is of the essence.

Sonetto: Please hand me the floppy disk, Regulus. I'll start the ritual ...

Sonetto: Hm? Regulus ... Where is she?

Male Investigator: It appears she triggered the ritual and disappeared in the chaos.

Sonetto: ...

Sonetto: A beam of dim light flashes behind the rock in the distance.

Choices

1. Pick up the records.

Vertin: She must've been in a rush, leaving all that behind.

Male Investigator: We'll have to make our way back on foot ... Chief, we need to give up the Regulus mission.

Female Investigator: The longer we stay here, the more likely we are to be caught in the "Storm." As I'm sure you know, Chief, if that happens ...

Female Investigator: ... you'll be disqualified as an investigator.

Sonetto: Let's split up.

Sonetto: You return to the Foundation and make the report. As Chief Investigator, I will stay until the last moment.

Vertin: What are you going to do after Regulus's registration? The "Storm" is about to come.

Sonetto: "Express gratitude, salute, and see them off. Never disturb the lives of the registrants."

Vertin: You haven't seen the "Storm" yet, have you?

Sonetto: I-I am not qualified. Thus far, you are the only one who can move freely during the "Storm."

Vertin: ...

Vertin: Have you found out where Regulus usually spends her time? Or anyone who knows her?

Male Investigator: Yes. She often turns up in the West End, hanging around Carnaby Street and King's Road.

Male Investigator: She used to buy records at the store on Kingly Court. She may've returned there.

Female Investigator: Oh, and be careful! She can control light with her arcane skills.

Vertin: I see. Let's go, Sonetto.

Sonetto: Are you coming with me? I thought you would leave after we defeated those Manus Vindictae ... Ahh, thank you!

Vertin: It's nothing. I have my own mission ...

Vertin: ... also in Kingly Court.

Invisible Pirate

PRO-04

When did it start to rain?

The cityscape is reflected in the puddle, swaying cheerfully with the ripples. The fashionable city, the optimistic people—looks as if the prosperity would last through all eras and never die.

Newsboy: EXTRA! EXTRA! READ ALL ABOUT IT!

Newsboy: The story of The Hero Pickles will be brought to the big screen! Rule, Britannia!

Sonetto: The Hero Pickles ... This is ...

Rockin' Girl: Hey, coming through! Tommy, is Regulus not here again today? If she doesn't show up, I'm taking that motorbike of hers.

Newsboy: Hey, don't be such a louse! Didn't you listen to the radio this morning? Her ship's been sunk!

Vertin: Are you talking about Regulus of the APPLe?

Newsboy: Who's asking?

Vertin: I'm her friend. She left something.

Newsboy: Huh! These are ...!

Newsboy: Looking at the records, the newsboy lets down his guard.

Newsboy: There's a good chance she's in the cafe over there. Just don't draw the attention of the coppers, eh?

Vertin: Thank you very much for your assistance.

Newsboy: You're very serious. If you really wanna thank me, just buy a copy of The Times.

Newsboy: See, it's all good news on the first two pages. That only comes along once in a thousand years!

Sonetto: I-I'll take a copy, please.

Sonetto: Sonetto puts away the newspaper carefully and runs towards the cafe while forcing herself to calm down.

Vertin: Do you like the world outside, Sonetto?

Sonetto: ...!

Sonetto: No ... I am just ...

Sonetto: I'm just curious. I'll throw it away when I've finished. Please don't think too much of it.

???: *chewing sound*

Sonetto: Hmm? That voice ...

Sonetto: Timekeeper, look at that table!

Sonetto: A piece of bread is floating in the air above a table of the cafe's, disappearing little by little.

Regulus: Mmm Mhm! Yummy! Mmm, so good!

Regulus: One more Earl Grey with brown sugar, please! ♪

Sonetto: Oh, now I understand! She's using an optical arcane skill to make herself invisible.

Sonetto: Sonetto takes out her pen quickly and points it at the cup held by "the invisible one."

Sonetto: Am himmel wechselt man die bühnenbilder!

Regulus: Whoa ...! Wh-what?!

Regulus: Ah! My tea!

Sonetto: Regulus, will you cooperate or not? I need your answer.

Regulus: ...

Regulus: The Foundation is an authority working with the government!

Regulus: If I register with you, my location will be exposed. You'll know where I am, no matter where I go.

Regulus: I am not doing it!

Regulus: Sonetto sighs and looks at the sky.

Regulus: It seems to be her habit before a battle.

Sonetto: ... May the peace be with us.

The Storm Overture

PRO-05

Regulus: Ouch! It hurts ... really hurts ...

Regulus: Regulus jumps back and falls heavily to the ground. She seems to be hurt badly.

Sonetto: Huh?!

Sonetto: I'm not finished yet. Stand up and continue the fight!

Regulus: Arm's broken! Oh! Bugger!

Vertin: Her face has gone pale ... Let me check her out.

Vertin: Vertin squats next to Regulus and blocks Sonetto's eyesight.

Choices

1. Give her something

Regulus: Wh-what are you doing?

Vertin: It's a Misty Bubble Ball. You know how to use it, right?

Regulus: Huh ...?

Vertin: I need your help. So until you can give it to me, I'll help you out.

Vertin: Meet me at the bookstore on Oxford Street.

Vertin: Now, push me.

Vertin: Shocked for half a second, Regulus pushes Vertin away with great strength.

Vertin: "Bang!"

Sonetto: Huh! Timekeeper ...!

Vertin: *coughs* ... Protect your eyes ...

Sonetto: I was careless. But ... we should be fine.

Sonetto: The effects of the Misty Bubble Ball only last so long. She can't have gotten far.

Vertin: Sonetto ... are you really going to continue the mission?

Vertin: The "Storm" will arrive shortly.

Vertin: If you don't go back now, it'll be too late.

Sonetto: At least ... let me search these stores again.

Sonetto: It's the same determined face. She put it on before every exam.

Sonetto: Sonetto strides over the rising puddles on the ground and runs into the department store.

Sonetto: Where to go now?

Sonetto: The bookstore on Oxford Street? No, of course not.

Sonetto: But to the place which she never agreed to meet at.

Regulus: Whoa! You scared me! Didn't we say the bookstore ...?

Vertin: Exactly. Isn't this the bookstore?

Vertin: Misty Bubble Balls have an easily traceable scent. Sonetto will be here any minute.

Regulus: So ... So what do you want from me?! I-I don't want any part of this!

Vertin: Relax. I'm not going to take you to the Foundation. I simply ask that you go somewhere safe with me.

Vertin: Regulus, I need you to **brave the "Storm"** with me.

Regulus: Brave the "Storm"?

Vertin: Shh! She's here.

Regulus: Fluctuation of arcane skills comes from outside. Vertin takes a mustache from the table and sticks it to Regulus's face immediately.

Sonetto: Timekeeper! Any progress ... on your end?

Vertin: I'm sorry ...

Sonetto: You're shaking your head ... That means ...

Sonetto: The mission ... We've ... failed ...?

Sonetto: A thunder brings Regulus back to her senses. She looks at her leather boots. They are already soaked by the "raindrops."

Sonetto: Pink raindrops, yellow raindrops, and blue raindrops are spreading like paints in water.

Sonetto: The edges of the buildings begin to melt. So bizarre, like the patterns in comic books.

Sonetto: Ti-Timekeeper ...

Sonetto: Her face is pale.

Sonetto: When will the "Storm" begin?

Vertin: In ten minutes.

Vertin: The collage of Richard Hamilton falls from the sky, splashing rain all over her.

Vertin: But she just nods in a hasty manner, her eyes seemingly frozen.

Sonetto: I should go. I have to go back.

Sonetto: ... Thank you very much for your support, Timekeeper.

Sonetto: Sonetto turns around and runs the way back.

Regulus: The rain ... is it rising from the ground?

Regulus: No more escaping. Regulus stands at the door, totally frozen with shock.

Regulus: She reaches out for the raindrops and watches them flying towards the sky through her fingers, feeling confused.

Regulus: Why is everyone acting as if nothing's happening? Are my eyes playing tricks on me?

Regulus: This is really, really weird.

Vertin: You can see it too, which proves you're the one I'm looking for.

Vertin: She draws back in haste until falling down in a puddle behind her.

Regulus: Looking for me? No. No way ...

Regulus: Are these hallucinations? Did you use a potion on me?!

Regulus: Why? I don't even have that "little thing" anymore!

Vertin: Enough! Stop running!

Vertin: The "Storm" is here.

Vertin: At the last moment, Vertin finally manages to open the suitcase and push Regulus inside.

Vertin: Look at the world through your own eyes!

What ...

What?

I'm not like them.

I am here to protect you.

The Living Past

PRO-06

Regulus: I ... This is ...

Regulus: I ... I don't get it ...

Vertin: It's alright. It's just ... the end of an era.

Vertin: And you survived.

Vertin: ...

Vertin: You've braved the "Storm." My experiment succeeded. Thank you for your help.

Regulus: What experiment? The end of an era ... What do you mean ...? I-I don't understand what you're talking about!

Vertin: Relax, Regulus. I will tell you, but not here.

Vertin: Say this with me ...

Vertin: "Ne iru milde en tiun bonan nokton."

Vertin: Hold my hand. Let me take you into the suitcase.

Regulus: The ... suitcase?

Vertin: Close your eyes.

Vertin: Follow me. All the way down to the end of the path and into the depths.

Regulus: It's dark. I ... I can't see anything ...

Regulus: Where, where are you taking me?

Vertin: A safe place. An "ark" ... sailing in the "Storm."

Regulus: ...!

Vertin: No one can follow us here. We can speak freely.

Regulus: Wow ... Giant stone statues, huge electronic machines, a whole wall of photos ...

Vertin: Please allow me to re-introduce myself.

Vertin: I'm from the St. Pavlov Foundation—the same place as the investigators you just met. We actually grew up there together.

Vertin: I am the Timekeeper. I keep track of time in the outside world.

Vertin: ... That is to say, I am the one who records the beginnings and ends of eras.

Regulus: ...!

Regulus: You're saying that ... these photos here are ...

Regulus: ... Huh? It's Lewis. I know him!

Vertin: Yes. I took this photo several days ago. He was selling Hoover upright vacuum cleaners in the West End and thought photos would help business, so he gladly posed for it.

Regulus: Why did you take a photo of him? How's he ...?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: This is Marion Smith, a single mother. She worried if she could afford to feed her child every night, but she never gave up her dream of being a writer.

Vertin: I met her at a snack bar at 2 a.m. Her one-act play about the Trans-Antarctic Expedition was a real masterpiece.

Vertin: This is Julie, who once invited me to her house. Her bedroom wall was covered with posters of Rivaldo ...

Vertin: ... the FIFA World Player of the Year, who then became a mass idol.

Regulus: Trans-Antarctica Expedition, Rivaldo, I've never heard of them.

Vertin: They're stories from a long, long time to come.

Vertin: These photos date forward to 1999. My time.

Regulus: ...

Vertin: Our time is going backwards, Regulus.

Vertin: At the countdown to the millennium, before the clock struck twelve, time reversed. We were sent back to the explosion of the supernova in the 80s, to the release of VHS ...

Vertin: .. and to the 1960s, where I met you.

Regulus: Time is going backwards?

Regulus: So the people in the photos—people like me—where are they now? Have they all been "reversed?"

Regulus: Like in the "Storm" just now?

Vertin: Maybe.

Vertin: I doubt I'll ever see them again.

Vertin: Before meeting you, I had done so many experiments.

Vertin: At one point, I discovered that my suitcase was able to cut the "Storm" out. It can preserve items from the last era too, like these photos.

Vertin: So I tried putting newspapers, mushrooms, even Wapaloosies into the case. They all succeeded. However, when it came to the friends I had made in the last era ...

Vertin: I failed.

Vertin: It doesn't work on ordinary people.

Vertin: Maybe I should just record the time ... Be a silent, emotionless observer ... Act as the Foundation has asked me to.

Regulus: But why are we ...

APPLe: Because we can see the mutation of the world? The unusual happenings before the "Storm" ... have left a deep impression on this APPLe.

Vertin: I think so.

Vertin: When you were out at sea, broadcasting on the radio, Regulus cried out, "Shout it to the full moon!"

Vertin: It was the beginning of the month. There couldn't have been a full moon that day. The real moon was to your west ... There were two that night.

Vertin: I realized that you could see what I see in this world. So ...

Vertin: I decided to try it again.

Vertin: One last time.

Regulus: ...

Regulus: Ah, umm ...?!

Regulus: Whoa, what's going on? Is that ... an earthquake?

Vertin: Not good. Seems our suitcase has been found.

Vertin: By critters maybe, or just someone passing by. Sorry, I need to leave for a while. Need to hide it somewhere safe.

Regulus: Hey. Wait.

Regulus: ... The things you're doing ... Does your boss know?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: This is my own will.

Vertin: I can't stand aside and watch you be taken away by Sonetto; have you disappear like the others in the "Storm."

Vertin: There's also something I need to find out for myself ...

Vertin: ... The truth.

Regulus: Solid.

Regulus: Mr. APPLe, could you please give Vertin a hand?

Regulus: I ... need some time to think about all this ...

Regulus: About everything you said.